

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Bookkeeping and Payroll English



Learner workbook

Work with realistic cases, develop your own response, and use the answer section after you have tried the tasks.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For Bookkeepers, accounts payable and receivable clerks, payroll clerks, and accounting assistants.

All organizations, records, amounts, deadlines, and incidents are fictional English-language practice. This course is not accounting, payroll-system, tax, employment-law, financial, or payment-processing advice. Internal deadlines in the exercises are not legal rules. Refer pay entitlements, deductions, posting treatments, corrections, and payment decisions to the responsible qualified people and applicable local requirements. Use invented employee and account details only.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Matching an invoice to its supporting records

Clarify which document supports a billed quantity.

02 Explaining receipts and outstanding customer balances

Explain why received cash and open invoice balances can coexist.

03 Qualifying a bank reconciliation difference

Report a traced item without overstating the reconciliation's completion.

04 Requesting evidence for time exceptions

Request confirmation of actual time without substituting a schedule for evidence.

05 Explaining a payroll preview

Explain a preview difference while separating arithmetic from approval.

06 Making approval status unambiguous

Give a payment status update that preserves each decision stage.

07 Handing over a period-close review

Hand over supporting facts and ownership without deciding accounting treatment.

08 Correcting records while preserving the trail

Repair an inaccurate status and preserve the distinction between an entry and a payment.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop to choose a vocabulary, grammar, role-play, or new-dialogue activity.

LESSON 01 / READ AND NOTICE

Matching an invoice to its supporting records

Clarify which document supports a billed quantity.

SITUATION

Fictional supplier Alder bills twelve desk lamps on invoice A184. Purchase order P61 lists twelve, but receiving record R9 lists ten. The remaining two may be on another delivery; no second record is available.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

invoice - A supplier's or seller's bill listing goods or services and the amount requested.

purchase order - A buyer's purchasing document specifying the goods or services ordered.

receiving record - A record of the goods or quantities actually received by an organization.

credit note - A seller's document reducing an amount previously billed, with a reference to the relevant charge.

Useful word combinations

match an invoice to an order: compare the supplier's bill with the purchasing reference

query a quantity difference: ask why billed and received quantities differ

link a credit note: connect a reduction to the original invoice

confirm receipt of goods: establish what arrived, not what was merely ordered

LESSON 01 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Locate the exact mismatch

3. Notice the language

Name the invoice, order, and receiving record separately. Agreement between two documents does not settle a third document's different quantity. Ask about the missing evidence without assuming either a supplier error or an unrecorded delivery.

The invoice shows ___, whereas the receiving record shows ___.

Could you confirm whether ___ arrived separately?

Which reference supports the remaining ___?

Compare this wording: Your invoice is wrong.

Clearer: The invoice lists twelve lamps, but our available receiving record lists ten. Was there a separate delivery?

The revised question identifies the evidence gap without treating an unexplained difference as a confirmed error.

4. Check the language

1. Bookkeeper: The order lists twelve and R9 lists ten.

Buyer: Please confirm ___ before we call the invoice fully matched.

- A. when the invoice becomes due
- B. who requested the twelve lamps
- C. whether the other two lamps were received
- D. the unit price on the original quotation

2. Supplier: Are you saying we overbilled you?

Bookkeeper: No; the difference is ___ until we check for another delivery.

- A. credited
- B. unresolved
- C. settled
- D. overdue

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Two lamps without a receiving reference

A fictional bookkeeper calls the buyer about invoice A184 and receiving record R9.

01 • Bookkeeper: Could you clarify the two-lamp difference on Alder's invoice? The receiving record shows only ten.

02 • Buyer: We ordered twelve, so I expected the invoice to show twelve as well.

03 • Bookkeeper: It does, but the order confirms our request rather than the quantity actually delivered.

04 • Buyer: That's fair. The warehouse mentioned another delivery, although I haven't seen its receiving record.

05 • Bookkeeper: Was that another lamp delivery, or could they have meant the chairs ordered separately?

06 • Buyer: I don't know yet. I can ask for the item description and delivery reference.

07 • Bookkeeper: Please do. For now, shall we describe two lamps as awaiting receipt confirmation?

08 • Buyer: Yes, that is more accurate than calling the supplier's bill incorrect at this stage.

09 • Bookkeeper: I've marked that specific difference for review. The other ten match the available record.

10 • Buyer: I'll check the second delivery with the warehouse and return the reference, not another order copy.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A credit note for the wrong invoice

A fictional supplier representative and clerk compare a credit note with two similar invoices.

01 • Clerk: Your credit note mentions invoice seventy, but our damaged shelf was billed on invoice seventeen.

02 • Supplier representative: Both invoices were for shelving. Could you tell me which delivery contained the damaged item?

03 • Clerk: The West office delivery on Monday. Invoice seventeen lists six shelves for that location.

04 • Supplier representative: I see the confusion. Invoice seventy belongs to the East office delivery the following week.

05 • Clerk: Then the amount alone won't establish which invoice the credit note should reduce, will it?

06 • Supplier representative: No. The amounts happen to match, but the delivery and invoice references are different.

07 • Clerk: Could you confirm the intended link before we apply the credit to either balance?

08 • Supplier representative: The intended invoice is seventeen. I will request a corrected credit note with that reference.

09 • Clerk: Thank you. I'll keep the existing note linked to this query until its replacement arrives.

10 • Supplier representative: Please label it pending correction; I have confirmed the intended link, not issued the replacement yet.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Cases or individual folders

A fictional invoice query concerns a supplier's unit of measure.

01 • Accounts clerk: The invoice shows four at thirty dollars each, but the receiving record lists forty folders.

02 • Purchasing assistant: That looks like a quantity difference. Did the supplier perhaps omit a zero?

03 • Accounts clerk: Before we conclude that, could you check whether four means cases rather than individual folders?

04 • Purchasing assistant: The purchase order says four cases, each containing ten folders. The price is per case.

05 • Accounts clerk: That explains forty individual folders. Does the invoice also identify the unit as a case?

06 • Purchasing assistant: Yes, in the description beside the item code. It's easy to miss in this layout.

07 • Accounts clerk: Then the quantities agree after comparing the same units: four cases equal forty folders.

08 • Purchasing assistant: Exactly. The price extension is one hundred twenty dollars for the four cases.

09 • Accounts clerk: I'll note the unit conversion in the query so the reviewer can follow the comparison.

10 • Purchasing assistant: And I'll ask receiving to include both cases and pieces next time, where the form permits.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Matching an invoice to its supporting records

Fictional supplier Alder bills twelve desk lamps on invoice A184. Purchase order P61 lists twelve, but receiving record R9 lists ten. The remaining two may be on another delivery; no second record is available.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Buyer: you ordered twelve lamps and can see only R9. The warehouse can check whether a second delivery occurred.

Second round: The supplier sends the purchase order again. Explain why it confirms the order quantity but not receipt.

Scenario 2 | A service invoice without a completion reference

Fictional invoice S12 bills two training sessions. The booking email confirms two sessions, but the completion record lists only one. The coordinator can check attendance records; the second session's status is unknown.

Role A: Bookkeeper: distinguish booked sessions from completed sessions and request the missing reference.

Role B: Training coordinator: one attendance list is available; the instructor holds the other session's records.

Possible opening: The booking covers two sessions, but I can currently support completion of only one.

Success checks

- Name the missing second-session evidence.
- Avoid calling the bill wrong before checking.
- Agree who will obtain the completion record.

Add a complication: The supplier resends the booking confirmation instead of completion evidence.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 02 / READ AND NOTICE

Explaining receipts and outstanding customer balances

Explain why received cash and open invoice balances can coexist.

SITUATION

Fictional customer Pine has invoices 410 for \$600 and 411 for \$400. A \$600 receipt is identified as Pine's but has no invoice reference. Both invoices remain open in the ledger pending allocation.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

accounts receivable - Amounts owed to an organization by customers for billed goods or services.

remittance advice - Information from a payer identifying the invoices or charges a payment is intended to cover.

unapplied cash - A recorded receipt that has not yet been allocated to a specific customer balance or invoice.

aging report - A report grouping unpaid balances by their age or time past due, using a stated date basis.

Useful word combinations

allocate a receipt: link received money to the relevant invoice

identify the payer: establish who sent a payment

request remittance details: ask which invoices a payment covers

review an aging balance: examine an amount grouped by how long it has remained unpaid

LESSON 02 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Separate receipt from allocation

3. Notice the language

A receipt records money received. Allocation connects it to a particular balance. Do not equate an unallocated receipt with nonpayment, or assume the customer's intended allocation from the amount alone.

We have received ___, but it has not been allocated to ___.

The open invoices total ___; the separate receipt is ___.

Which invoice does your remittance identify?

Compare this wording: You still owe us a thousand dollars.

Clearer: The open invoices total a thousand dollars, and we also have your six-hundred-dollar receipt awaiting allocation.

The correction acknowledges cash already received instead of presenting the gross invoice balance as the entire position.

4. Check the language

1. Customer: You recorded my payment without an invoice reference. Why are both invoices still open?

Clerk: The receipt is confirmed, but its ___ is pending.

- A. write-off
- B. allocation
- C. clearance
- D. refund

2. Clerk: Our aging report still lists both invoices.

Supervisor: Explain the balance ___ the unapplied receipt, so the customer sees both.

- A. alongside
- B. instead of
- C. regardless of
- D. ahead of

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Pine's payment without an invoice number

A fictional customer and clerk resolve the intended allocation of a recorded \$600 receipt.

01 • Receivables clerk: We have your six-hundred-dollar receipt, but its invoice reference was blank. Which invoice did you intend?

02 • Customer: I expected it to clear the account. Your statement still shows two invoices as unpaid.

03 • Receivables clerk: The invoices total one thousand dollars. The six hundred appears separately as unapplied cash.

04 • Customer: So the statement isn't saying that you never received the money I sent last week?

05 • Receivables clerk: Correct. Receipt is confirmed; the link to an invoice is the part we need to establish.

06 • Customer: I've opened our remittance advice. It lists invoice four ten for the six hundred.

07 • Receivables clerk: Thank you. That identifies the intended allocation and leaves invoice four eleven for four hundred.

08 • Customer: Please confirm that distinction when you send the updated account view after allocation.

09 • Receivables clerk: I'll request the allocation using this reference; I won't describe the ledger change as already completed.

10 • Customer: Then I'll review invoice four eleven separately. We agree what the receipt was intended to cover.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A receipt across two invoices

A fictional clerk checks a customer's breakdown of a combined payment.

01 • Customer: I sent nine hundred dollars, but the email mentioned only invoice eighty-one. Is that a problem?

02 • Receivables clerk: It leaves the allocation unclear because invoice eighty-one is for six hundred dollars, not nine hundred.

03 • Customer: The other three hundred relates to invoice eighty-two. I left that reference out by mistake.

04 • Receivables clerk: Thanks. Are you disputing any part of eighty-two, or is this simply a partial payment?

05 • Customer: It's a partial payment. That invoice totals five hundred, and two hundred remains unpaid.

06 • Receivables clerk: Then your breakdown is six hundred to eighty-one and three hundred to eighty-two, correct?

07 • Customer: Yes. I can provide the same breakdown through our usual remittance channel this afternoon.

08 • Receivables clerk: That will support the allocation request. We already have the nine-hundred-dollar receipt recorded.

09 • Customer: Please don't describe the remaining two hundred as another missing receipt; we haven't sent it.

10 • Receivables clerk: I'll distinguish the allocation clarification from the remaining balance so the account view stays understandable.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Which date drives the aging column?

A fictional customer queries why an invoice appears in a report's overdue group.

01 • Customer: Invoice ninety appears overdue, but your team sent me another copy yesterday.

02 • Accounts clerk: The aging report uses the recorded due date, not when we resend a copy.

03 • Customer: I thought receiving a new copy meant the payment period started again from that day.

04 • Accounts clerk: A copy doesn't by itself change the recorded terms. Do you have an agreed revised due date?

05 • Customer: Yes, our account contact confirmed next Friday in an email. It may not have reached you.

06 • Accounts clerk: Could you forward that reference? Our current record still shows the original date last Monday.

07 • Customer: Certainly. I'm asking you to review that agreement, not automatically treat the copy as an extension.

08 • Accounts clerk: That distinction helps. I'll mark the due date for review against the account contact's confirmation.

09 • Customer: Until then, could your explanation say the aging status is being checked rather than settled?

10 • Accounts clerk: Yes. The report reflects the current record, while the revised-date evidence remains to be reviewed.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Explaining receipts and outstanding customer balances

Fictional customer Pine has invoices 410 for \$600 and 411 for \$400. A \$600 receipt is identified as Pine's but has no invoice reference. Both invoices remain open in the ledger pending allocation.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Customer: the receipt is yours, but you must check your payment listing to confirm the invoice reference. Ask why the aging report still includes both invoices.

Second round: The amount equals invoice 410. Explain why that is a useful clue, not confirmation of the intended allocation.

Scenario 2 | The receipt belongs to a sister company

A fictional \$800 receipt names Cedar Group. Cedar North owes \$800 and Cedar South owes \$500. The remittance contact knows which entity paid but the bank reference omits it.

Role A: Receivables clerk: ask for the paying entity and invoice reference without allocating solely by amount.

Role B: Customer contact: the payment came from Cedar North for invoice N8; provide this only after the clerk asks.

Possible opening: Could you confirm which Cedar entity sent the eight hundred dollars and which invoice it covers?

Success checks

- Confirm the entity and invoice separately.
- Acknowledge the receipt without calling both accounts cleared.
- Restate the supplied N8 allocation.

Add a complication: A colleague says the matching amount makes the entity question unnecessary.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 03 / READ AND NOTICE

Qualifying a bank reconciliation difference

Report a traced item without overstating the reconciliation's completion.

SITUATION

In a fictional reconciliation through June 30, the bank balance is \$300 lower than the cash ledger. A \$300 deposit recorded June 30 appears on the bank's July 1 activity. Other reconciliation checks are not complete.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

bank reconciliation - A comparison explaining differences between bank records and the organization's corresponding cash records.

outstanding payment - A payment recorded internally that has not yet appeared as cleared in the bank activity being reviewed.

deposit in transit - A deposit recorded internally but not yet reflected in the bank records at the reconciliation date.

reconciling item - An identified difference between records that must be explained, cleared, or corrected during reconciliation.

Useful word combinations

align the statement dates: compare records through the same day

trace a statement entry: find the related internal transaction

carry an open reconciling item: retain an unexplained difference for follow-up

clear an outstanding payment: confirm that a recorded payment appears in bank activity

LESSON 03 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

State what one match establishes

3. Notice the language

Separate the evidence for an individual item from the conclusion about the whole account. 'Consistent with' allows a supported explanation without claiming that every other entry has been checked.

This entry is consistent with ___ because ___.

We have traced ___; we have not completed ___.

The evidence supports ___ for this item only.

Compare this wording: The bank is three hundred short.

Clearer: The difference matches a deposit recorded internally on June thirty and appearing at the bank on July first.

The revision describes a supported timing difference instead of suggesting missing money.

4. Check the language

1. Reviewer: Does the matched deposit finish the reconciliation?

Bookkeeper: It explains this item; the remaining checks are ____.

A. outstanding

B. complete

C. waived

D. duplicated

2. Manager: Can we report a missing deposit?

Bookkeeper: July first activity shows it, so this is ____ a timing difference.

A. contradicted by

B. independent of

C. unrelated to

D. consistent with

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A deposit appears one day later

A fictional reviewer discusses the June 30 reconciliation with the bookkeeper.

01 • Reviewer: The bank balance is three hundred lower. Have you found anything that explains that difference?

02 • Bookkeeper: Yes. That deposit in transit appears in the bank's July first activity for three hundred.

03 • Reviewer: Does the reference match, or are we relying only on two amounts that happen to agree?

04 • Bookkeeper: The deposit reference matches as well. That supports a timing explanation for this particular item.

05 • Reviewer: Then can I mark the account reconciled and move it to the completed folder?

06 • Bookkeeper: Not yet. The deposit is traced, but the other reconciliation checks are still open.

07 • Reviewer: Which wording separates that progress from the overall status without making it sound like nothing happened?

08 • Bookkeeper: Deposit timing confirmed for this item; the remaining account checks are pending.

09 • Reviewer: That works. Keep the July first reference with the June reconciliation so the reviewer can follow it.

10 • Bookkeeper: I've linked it and kept the overall status open. The evidence supports the item, not completion.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Equal totals with an unmatched pair

A fictional reconciliation review finds two equal and opposite unexplained amounts.

01 • Bookkeeper: The totals agree, but I still have an unmatched forty-dollar receipt and forty-dollar payment.

02 • Reviewer: Could those simply cancel out, leaving us with no reconciliation work to do?

03 • Bookkeeper: They offset numerically, but they may relate to different transactions. We haven't identified either one.

04 • Reviewer: What would be misleading about calling the difference zero and closing both questions now?

05 • Bookkeeper: Zero describes the net total. It doesn't establish that the individual entries are correctly recorded.

06 • Reviewer: Understood. Can you show them as two separate reconciling items rather than one net line?

07 • Bookkeeper: Yes. That preserves each reference, direction, and open question for the person tracing them.

08 • Reviewer: I'll take the receipt query. Could you ask the payments clerk about the outgoing forty?

09 • Bookkeeper: I will, and neither item will be labeled cleared merely because the amounts are equal.

10 • Reviewer: Then our summary is totals agree, two unmatched items remain. That's a useful qualified result.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A bank fee or a look-alike amount

A fictional clerk checks an unexplained bank debit with a senior bookkeeper.

01 • Clerk: There's a fifteen-dollar bank debit without a matching ledger entry. Last month's fee was fifteen too.

02 • Senior bookkeeper: That makes a fee plausible, but does this statement actually describe the debit as a fee?

03 • Clerk: No. It shows a short reference that I haven't yet matched to a transaction description.

04 • Senior bookkeeper: Then we should call it an unidentified debit rather than repeat last month's explanation as fact.

05 • Clerk: The detailed statement view is available. Would its description be useful evidence for the query?

06 • Senior bookkeeper: Yes, use that reference. We need to establish what this debit represents before discussing any entry.

07 • Clerk: I've opened it now. It identifies a returned transfer charge, rather than the monthly account fee.

08 • Senior bookkeeper: That narrows the explanation. The responsible reviewer still needs to confirm its handling in our records.

09 • Clerk: I'll replace the guessed monthly-fee label with the statement's description and supporting reference.

10 • Senior bookkeeper: We've identified the bank description; the ledger review remains incomplete.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Qualifying a bank reconciliation difference

In a fictional reconciliation through June 30, the bank balance is \$300 lower than the cash ledger. A \$300 deposit recorded June 30 appears on the bank's July 1 activity. Other reconciliation checks are not complete.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Reviewer: you can see the July first entry and want to know whether the entire account has been checked.

Second round: A colleague says equal balances prove every entry is right. Distinguish agreeing totals from checking the underlying items.

Scenario 2 | A cheque still absent from bank activity

A fictional \$420 cheque is recorded on August 28 but absent from bank activity through August 31. The recipient has not confirmed receipt. No loss or cancellation is established.

Role A: Bookkeeper: explain the outstanding payment and ask what evidence is needed.

Role B: Payments clerk: you have the issue record but no delivery or bank-clearing confirmation.

Possible opening: The cheque is recorded internally, but it has not appeared in the bank activity we reviewed.

Success checks

- Keep issued, received, and cleared distinct.
- Do not infer loss from absence at this cutoff.
- Assign follow-up on receipt and later bank activity.

Add a complication: Someone calls it lost because it is not yet cleared.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 04 / READ AND NOTICE

Requesting evidence for time exceptions

Request confirmation of actual time without substituting a schedule for evidence.

SITUATION

Fictional employee Eli's Tuesday timecard lacks a clock-out entry. The roster says 17:00, but Eli recalls 17:30. The supervisor can review a work log before the internal approval cutoff at 14:00 today. Actual finish time is unconfirmed.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

time exception - A timekeeping record flagged because information is missing, inconsistent, or requires review.

missing punch - An absent clock-in or clock-out entry in an employee's time record.

pay period - The defined span of work time covered by a payroll calculation.

approval cutoff - An organization's stated internal deadline for receiving approvals for a particular processing cycle.

Useful word combinations

resolve a missing punch: confirm an absent clock entry with supporting information

confirm actual hours: distinguish time worked from the planned roster

flag a time exception: identify a record needing review

meet the approval cutoff: provide a decision by the employer's stated internal deadline

LESSON 04 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Ask for the missing time fact

3. Notice the language

Describe the absent entry and the conflicting information. An internal cutoff is a workflow deadline, not a statement about legal pay obligations. Ask the responsible reviewer for evidence and a status if the question cannot be resolved.

Could you confirm the actual ___ against ___?

The roster shows ___, while the employee recalls ___.

Please return either the confirmed detail or the open issue by ___.

Compare this wording: Please approve the usual hours.

Clearer: Please check the missing Tuesday clock-out against the work log; the roster and Eli's recollection differ by thirty minutes.

The request asks for the disputed fact rather than treating usual hours as actual hours.

4. Check the language

1. Supervisor: What do you need before two?

Payroll clerk: Please confirm ___ on Tuesday, rather than the scheduled finish.

- A. who prepared the weekly roster
- B. when the next pay period begins
- C. whether the usual shift is eight hours
- D. what time Eli actually finished

2. Payroll clerk: Can you send the reviewed exception by two?

Supervisor: Yes, I can return it ___ two, possibly earlier.

- A. since
- B. during
- C. by
- D. until

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Eli's missing Tuesday finish

A fictional payroll clerk requests evidence before the internal two o'clock cutoff.

01 • Payroll clerk: Eli's missing punch concerns Tuesday's clock-out. Could you check it before our two o'clock approval cutoff?

02 • Supervisor: The roster shows five. Would confirming that scheduled finish give you what you need?

03 • Payroll clerk: Not quite. Eli recalls five thirty, so we need the actual finish rather than the planned one.

04 • Supervisor: I can review the work log by one thirty. Does the exception show Tuesday's date?

05 • Payroll clerk: Yes, Tuesday the ninth. Please return either the supported correction or a clear unresolved status.

06 • Supervisor: Understood. If the log only repeats the roster, I can't treat it as independent confirmation.

07 • Payroll clerk: Exactly. We would still need someone who can confirm when the work actually ended.

08 • Supervisor: I'll speak to Eli if the log doesn't settle it and keep the reviewer informed.

09 • Payroll clerk: Thank you. The time exception remains open; no finish time has been confirmed during this call.

10 • Supervisor: I accept Tuesday's check and will return its status before two.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

An overnight shift crosses the date line

A fictional payroll clerk and shift supervisor clarify two timecard entries.

01 • Payroll clerk: The timecard starts at ten on Thursday and ends at six on Friday. Is this one shift?

02 • Shift supervisor: Yes, it continued overnight. Why does the exception list Thursday as missing a finish?

03 • Payroll clerk: The import grouped entries by calendar date, so Friday's finish appears on a separate line.

04 • Shift supervisor: Then the person may have entered both punches correctly. Could you check the linked shift record?

05 • Payroll clerk: I have it open. The start and finish carry the same shift reference, N18.

06 • Shift supervisor: That supports treating them as linked records for review, rather than asking for an invented Thursday finish.

07 • Payroll clerk: Agreed. I will send both dated entries with N18 to the timekeeping reviewer.

08 • Shift supervisor: Please preserve the actual dates. We shouldn't make Friday's finish look as if it happened Thursday.

09 • Payroll clerk: I'll describe this as a date-grouping exception with both punches present.

10 • Shift supervisor: That's accurate. Any pay calculation can then use the reviewed record and the applicable rules.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Two supervisors each expect the other to approve

A fictional payroll assistant resolves ownership of an internal time approval.

01 • Payroll assistant: Dana's timecard is complete, but neither department has accepted the approval task for the transferred week.

02 • Team supervisor: I assumed the previous supervisor would approve it because Dana started the week there.

03 • Payroll assistant: They assumed you would approve the whole week. The internal cutoff is tomorrow at noon.

04 • Team supervisor: Can we clarify who reviews which dates? I supervised Thursday and Friday only.

05 • Payroll assistant: Yes. I need named reviewers for Monday through Wednesday and for Thursday through Friday.

06 • Team supervisor: I can accept Thursday and Friday. The earlier supervisor needs to confirm the first three days.

07 • Payroll assistant: I'll send that split to both of you and ask the earlier supervisor to acknowledge their part.

08 • Team supervisor: Please make clear that my acceptance is not confirmation of days I did not supervise.

09 • Payroll assistant: Understood. Your two-day review is assigned; the three-day review still needs an owner.

10 • Team supervisor: That gives us a concrete gap to resolve before noon rather than two assumptions of completion.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Requesting evidence for time exceptions

Fictional employee Eli's Tuesday timecard lacks a clock-out entry. The roster says 17:00, but Eli recalls 17:30. The supervisor can review a work log before the internal approval cutoff at 14:00 today. Actual finish time is unconfirmed.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Supervisor: you can review the work log by 13:30 but have not seen it yet. Ask which date and entry are in dispute.

Second round: The reviewer finds only the planned roster. Keep the actual finish time unresolved and identify the next evidence holder.

Scenario 2 | An exception arrives after the internal cutoff

A fictional time exception is received at 14:20 after a 14:00 internal cutoff. The employee disputes one hour. The payroll lead can review late-item handling at 15:00; no payment timing decision is supplied.

Role A: Payroll assistant: acknowledge receipt and escalate the specific exception without promising when money will arrive.

Role B: Supervisor: ask whether late receipt means the disputed hour will never be reviewed.

Possible opening: We received the one-hour query at two twenty; I have asked the payroll lead to review its handling at three.

Success checks

- State the actual receipt time and pending review.
- Do not turn an internal cutoff into a legal pay rule.
- Confirm who will communicate the handling decision.

Add a complication: The supervisor asks for a guaranteed correction in today's payment.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 05 / READ AND NOTICE

Explaining a payroll preview

Explain a preview difference while separating arithmetic from approval.

SITUATION

Fictional preview A shows Morgan's gross pay of \$1,200, deductions of \$200, and net pay of \$1,000. Preview B shows the same gross pay, deductions of \$250, and net pay of \$950. A new \$50 deduction line is present; its supporting record is pending.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

gross pay - An employee's earnings amount before deductions for the specified payroll period.

deduction - An amount subtracted from gross pay, recorded under a specified reason or category.

net pay - The amount remaining after deductions are subtracted from gross pay.

payroll register - A payroll report listing employee earnings, deductions, and payment amounts for a processing run.

Useful word combinations

compare payroll previews: check two versions before final processing

trace a deduction line: locate the record supporting an amount withheld

reconcile the headcount: explain a difference in the number of employees listed

identify a one-time payment: distinguish a single payment from a recurring amount

LESSON 05 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Compare like-for-like payroll figures

3. Notice the language

Keep the employee and pay period constant. Name gross pay, deductions, and net pay instead of using 'pay' for all three. A figure that adds up may still need supporting documentation.

Gross pay is unchanged, whereas ___ differs by ___.

The arithmetic difference comes from ___; the support is ___.

Are both previews for the same ___?

Compare this wording: Morgan's salary has gone down.

Clearer: Gross pay is unchanged; the preview shows fifty dollars more in deductions and fifty dollars less in net pay.

The revision avoids describing a deduction change as a change in the underlying gross earnings.

4. Check the language

1. Employee: Did my gross pay change between these previews?

Clerk: No; gross pay is unchanged, ___ deductions increased by fifty dollars.

A. unless

B. before

C. whereas

D. because

2. Reviewer: The figures add up. Is the new deduction approved?

Clerk: Its arithmetic is explained, but the supporting record is ____.

A. balanced

B. pending

C. recurring

D. net

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Morgan's fifty-dollar preview difference

A fictional payroll reviewer and clerk compare previews A and B for the same employee and period.

01 • Reviewer: Preview B shows nine hundred fifty net pay. Did Morgan's gross pay fall by fifty?

02 • Payroll clerk: No. Gross pay stays at twelve hundred. Deductions rise from two hundred to two hundred fifty.

03 • Reviewer: So the extra deduction explains the displayed net difference, but not necessarily whether that deduction belongs?

04 • Payroll clerk: Exactly. The new fifty-dollar line has no supporting record attached yet, so its basis remains unconfirmed.

05 • Reviewer: Are we comparing the same employee and period, rather than differently filtered reports?

06 • Payroll clerk: Yes, Morgan and the same period. I checked both headings before comparing the lines.

07 • Reviewer: Please don't label the additional deduction as a tax change without evidence of its actual category.

08 • Payroll clerk: I won't. I'll refer the new line and missing support to the payroll lead.

09 • Reviewer: Then the preview comparison is complete, but approval of that line remains a separate question.

10 • Payroll clerk: Correct. Gross unchanged, deductions fifty higher, net fifty lower, with the new line awaiting review.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A one-time amount disappears from the next preview

A fictional employee asks about differing gross figures across two payroll previews.

01 • Employee: My current preview is lower than the previous one. Has someone changed my regular rate?

02 • Payroll clerk: The earlier preview includes a separate one-time payment. The regular earnings lines show the same rate.

03 • Employee: Which line accounts for the difference? I only compared the total at the bottom.

04 • Payroll clerk: The line labeled recognition payment appears in the earlier period for one hundred dollars only.

05 • Employee: So that explains the gross difference between these two previews, without implying a lower regular rate?

06 • Payroll clerk: Yes. The displayed regular rate is unchanged. I can show you the two lines separately.

07 • Employee: I also have a question about a deduction, but that sounds like a different comparison.

08 • Payroll clerk: It is. Let's identify the deduction reference and have the payroll specialist review its basis.

09 • Employee: Thank you. For the earnings question, I'll compare regular amounts separately from the one-time payment.

10 • Payroll clerk: That gives a clearer comparison. The separate deduction question remains open for the specialist.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

One more employee in the register

A fictional payroll assistant explains a headcount difference to a reviewer.

01 • Reviewer: The payroll register lists twenty-one employees, but the department list has twenty. Which one is wrong?

02 • Payroll assistant: The department list excludes transferred staff. The register includes one employee with earnings for the earlier dates.

03 • Reviewer: So the two totals may use different populations rather than reflect a duplicate employee?

04 • Payroll assistant: Yes. The extra name is Rowan, whose transfer took effect halfway through the pay period.

05 • Reviewer: Have you confirmed that Rowan appears only once in the register we're reviewing now?

06 • Payroll assistant: Yes, once under the same employee reference. The earnings allocation still needs the department split checked.

07 • Reviewer: Then let's not remove the line simply to make the headcount agree with the current list.

08 • Payroll assistant: Agreed. I'll explain the population difference and show the transfer date beside Rowan's record.

09 • Reviewer: Please identify the remaining department-allocation review separately from the already-checked duplicate-name question.

10 • Payroll assistant: I have. Twenty-one register entries, twenty current department members, and one transfer allocation awaiting review.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Explaining a payroll preview

Fictional preview A shows Morgan's gross pay of \$1,200, deductions of \$200, and net pay of \$1,000. Preview B shows the same gross pay, deductions of \$250, and net pay of \$950. A new \$50 deduction line is present; its supporting record is pending.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Payroll reviewer: ask whether both previews cover Morgan and the same period, then request the source for the additional deduction.

Second round: Someone calls the extra fifty dollars a tax change. Explain that the line's reason is unconfirmed and requires the responsible specialist's review.

Scenario 2 | A year-to-date column mistaken for current pay

A fictional payslip preview lists current gross pay of \$900 and year-to-date gross pay of \$9,900. The employee thinks \$9,900 is the current payment. Deductions and final payment status are not supplied.

Role A: Payroll clerk: explain the two time spans without inventing a net amount.

Role B: Employee: ask which figure belongs to this period and whether it equals the bank payment.

Possible opening: The nine hundred is current gross pay; nine thousand nine hundred is the accumulated gross amount for the year.

Success checks

- Explain current versus accumulated totals.
- Distinguish gross pay from net pay.
- Leave the unsupplied payment amount unconfirmed.

Add a complication: The employee asks you to confirm the exact deposit based on gross pay alone.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 06 / READ AND NOTICE

Making approval status unambiguous

Give a payment status update that preserves each decision stage.

SITUATION

A fictional payment batch contains eight invoices. Seven have recorded approval; invoice V22 awaits a receiving document and is excluded from the proposed seven-item batch. The batch itself has not been released. The approver returns at 15:00.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

payment batch - A group of payment instructions assembled for review or processing together.

approval matrix - An organization's guide assigning approval authority by transaction type, amount, or other criteria.

delegated approver - A person given specified approval responsibility by someone with the authority to delegate it.

supporting document - A record supplying evidence for a transaction, its amount, purpose, receipt, or approval.

Useful word combinations

submit a batch for review: send a grouped set of proposed payments to the reviewer

confirm approval authority: check who may approve the specific item

exclude a disputed item: keep it outside the proposed batch while it is reviewed

retain the supporting reference: preserve the link to evidence behind a payment

LESSON 06 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Report approved, proposed, and released separately

3. Notice the language

Approval of an invoice, approval of a batch, and release of payment may be separate events. Use the fictional organization's stated stages, and avoid saying 'paid' merely because review is complete.

___ items have approval; ___ remains excluded.

The batch is proposed, not yet ___.

The next review can address ___ when ___.

Compare this wording: Seven invoices are paid.

Clearer: Seven invoices have recorded approval; their proposed payment batch has not been released.

The revised status does not turn completed review into completed payment.

4. Check the language

1. Manager: Has the seven-item batch gone out?

Clerk: No, it has been prepared ___ release.

- A. regardless of
- B. but is awaiting
- C. following
- D. in place of

2. Approver: What is stopping V22 from joining the proposal?

Clerk: Its ___ is missing; the quantity cannot yet be matched.

- A. receiving document
- B. payment date
- C. bank balance
- D. approval matrix

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Seven approved invoices are not seven completed payments

A fictional clerk updates a manager on the proposed batch and excluded V22.

01 • Manager: Can I tell purchasing that the eight-invoice payment batch has been paid this morning?

02 • Accounts clerk: No. Seven invoices have recorded approval, but their proposed batch hasn't been released. V22 remains excluded.

03 • Manager: What's missing for V22, and does its problem affect the description of the other seven?

04 • Accounts clerk: Its receiving document is missing. The other seven have approval, though none is reported as released here.

05 • Manager: When will someone review the proposed batch rather than simply the individual invoice records?

06 • Accounts clerk: The approver returns at three. I can present the seven-item proposal then.

07 • Manager: Please make the status clear now, because purchasing is waiting to answer a supplier's question.

08 • Accounts clerk: Seven invoices approved, proposed batch not released, V22 excluded pending receipt evidence. That's the current position.

09 • Manager: Thank you. I'll relay those separate stages and avoid promising a payment date to the supplier.

10 • Accounts clerk: I'll update the release status when confirmed and keep the V22 document query visible separately.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A delegation that covers only smaller invoices

A fictional clerk checks a substitute reviewer's stated authority.

01 • Accounts clerk: The usual approver is away. Could you confirm whether your delegation covers this twelve-hundred-dollar invoice?

02 • Deputy manager: I can approve department purchases up to one thousand. I hadn't noticed this one exceeded that limit.

03 • Accounts clerk: Thanks for checking. The approval matrix also names the finance manager for items above that threshold.

04 • Deputy manager: Then forwarding it to me wouldn't complete approval, even though I manage the department today.

05 • Accounts clerk: Correct. We need the named finance review, not just a senior colleague's acknowledgment.

06 • Deputy manager: I can confirm that the goods were received, but I can't supply that final approval.

07 • Accounts clerk: That confirmation is useful support. I'll keep it separate from the remaining approval requirement.

08 • Deputy manager: Please tell the finance manager what I've verified so they don't have to ask again.

09 • Accounts clerk: I'll include your receipt confirmation and explain that your delegated approver limit is exceeded.

10 • Deputy manager: Then the handover is clear: receipt checked, finance approval pending, and no payment release confirmed.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

The attachment is not the approved version

A fictional invoice clerk checks conflicting attachment versions with an approver.

01 • Invoice clerk: Your approval note refers to version two, but the batch attachment is still version one.

02 • Approver: Version two removes a delivery charge. Can you see that difference in the attached amount?

03 • Invoice clerk: Yes. The batch shows the higher amount from version one, so the approval and attachment don't agree.

04 • Approver: Please present the corrected attachment for review before anyone describes the batch total as approved.

05 • Invoice clerk: Should I retain version one in the history with a clear superseded label?

06 • Approver: Yes, that explains why the amount changed. The current proposal should point clearly to version two.

07 • Invoice clerk: I've corrected the proposal reference and recalculated its displayed total for your review.

08 • Approver: I can now see version two and the reduced amount. That resolves the document-version mismatch.

09 • Invoice clerk: I'll record your review of this proposal separately from any later payment release.

10 • Approver: Please do. We have clarified the approved amount here, not confirmed that money has left the bank.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Making approval status unambiguous

A fictional payment batch contains eight invoices. Seven have recorded approval; invoice V22 awaits a receiving document and is excluded from the proposed seven-item batch. The batch itself has not been released. The approver returns at 15:00.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Manager: distinguish the number of approved invoices from the number of released payments. Ask when the approver is available.

Second round: A substitute colleague offers to approve the batch. Ask whether the recorded delegation covers this batch, without assuming seniority equals authority.

Scenario 2 | The approver confirms receipt of the email only

A fictional approver replies 'Received, thank you' to a four-invoice proposal. No decision is stated. The clerk can ask for explicit approval or a query before the 16:00 review meeting.

Role A: Accounts clerk: ask whether the reply acknowledges delivery or records a decision.

Role B: Approver: you only acknowledged the email and will review the proposal at 15:30.

Possible opening: Does your reply confirm receipt of the proposal, or have you completed the approval review?

Success checks

- Distinguish acknowledgment from approval.
- State the supplied review time without inventing a decision.
- Keep the proposal pending until a decision is given.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to mark all four invoices approved based on the acknowledgment.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 07 / READ AND NOTICE

Handing over a period-close review

Hand over supporting facts and ownership without deciding accounting treatment.

SITUATION

Fictional June close has nine of ten checklist items complete. A \$240 maintenance invoice dated July 2 describes June service. Its posting period needs the accountant's review; no adjusting entry has been approved. Alex takes over the open-item follow-up at noon.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

close checklist - A list tracking required checks and review tasks at the end of an accounting period.

posting period - The accounting period to which an entry is assigned in the ledger.

adjusting entry - An accounting entry made to correct or update recorded balances, subject to the applicable review.

trial balance - A listing of ledger account balances used to compare total debits and credits at a stated point.

Useful word combinations

complete a close checklist: finish and record the specified closing checks

confirm the posting period: establish the accounting period assigned to an entry

submit an adjustment for review: present a proposed correction to the reviewer

tie a schedule to the ledger: compare a supporting total with the recorded account balance

LESSON 07 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Transfer the unresolved accounting question

3. Notice the language

Invoice date, service period, and posting period can differ. Preserve them separately and name the person who will obtain the accountant's decision. A balanced trial balance does not answer every period question.

The completed checks are ____; the remaining question is ____.

The invoice date is ____, but the service description says ____.

Please confirm you are taking over ____.

Compare this wording: June is basically closed; ask someone about maintenance.

Clearer: Nine checks are complete. Alex is taking over the maintenance invoice's posting-period query with the accountant.

The revision identifies the unfinished work and its owner without implying the close is complete.

4. Check the language

1. Alex: Has the maintenance adjustment been posted?

Bookkeeper: No; the posting period is ____ the accountant's review.

- A. subject to
- B. separate from
- C. evidence of
- D. subsequent to

2. Bookkeeper: Please confirm the handover.

Alex: I ____ the posting-period query; the accounting decision remains with the accountant.

- A. have completed
- B. have approved
- C. am reversing
- D. am taking over

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Alex takes the maintenance-period query

A fictional noon handover concerns the final June close item.

01 • Bookkeeper: Nine June checks are complete. The maintenance invoice for two hundred forty dollars remains the open item.

02 • Alex: Is its invoice date missing, or is the question which period it belongs to?

03 • Bookkeeper: It is dated July second and describes June service. The posting period needs the accountant's review.

04 • Alex: Has anyone already approved an adjusting entry that I need to follow through?

05 • Bookkeeper: No adjustment is approved. Please take over the query without treating either date as the accounting decision.

06 • Alex: I accept the follow-up. Where are the invoice and the note showing that review is still pending?

07 • Bookkeeper: They're linked under maintenance in the close checklist. The service description is visible on the invoice.

08 • Alex: I'll give the accountant both dates and ask for the posting-period decision.

09 • Bookkeeper: Thank you. Until that outcome is recorded, the checklist should stay at nine completed checks.

10 • Alex: Agreed. I own follow-up from noon; the accountant decides treatment.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A balanced trial balance with a missing reference

A fictional assistant asks a reviewer whether equal totals settle an open close question.

01 • Accounts assistant: The trial balance totals agree. Can I close the equipment query without its invoice reference?

02 • Close reviewer: Matching debit and credit totals don't establish that each entry has proper support.

03 • Accounts assistant: The amount and posting date are present, but I can't trace the equipment entry to its invoice.

04 • Close reviewer: Then the supporting-reference check remains open. It is a different question from whether the totals balance.

05 • Accounts assistant: Who should receive it now? The buyer holds the purchase file and can search the reference.

06 • Close reviewer: Please hand that search to the buyer, with the amount, date, and equipment description already available.

07 • Accounts assistant: I'll ask the buyer to accept the search, not simply copy them on an email.

08 • Close reviewer: Good. Keep the trial balance result as completed while leaving the document query visible.

09 • Accounts assistant: So our update distinguishes a balanced listing from a complete set of supporting records.

10 • Close reviewer: Exactly. Both findings matter, and the missing reference has a concrete next owner.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A schedule total agrees after one item is added

A fictional bookkeeper hands a corrected supporting schedule to a reviewer.

01 • Bookkeeper: The supplier schedule now agrees with the ledger after I included the omitted sixty-dollar item.

02 • Reviewer: Was the item missing from the ledger too, or only from the supporting schedule?

03 • Bookkeeper: Only from the schedule. The ledger already contained it under invoice L6 before today's correction.

04 • Reviewer: Then we shouldn't describe this as a new posting or an adjusting entry to the accounts.

05 • Bookkeeper: Correct. I revised the schedule total and linked L6 so you can check the change.

06 • Reviewer: Have you kept the earlier schedule version so the review trail explains the original mismatch?

07 • Bookkeeper: Yes, version one remains marked superseded. Version two includes the extra line and corrected total.

08 • Reviewer: I'll take the schedule review now. Does anything else remain open for this account?

09 • Bookkeeper: The document review is yours; I haven't identified another difference, but your check remains pending.

10 • Reviewer: Understood. I'm accepting the corrected schedule for review, not retrospectively treating the first version as accurate.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Handing over a period-close review

Fictional June close has nine of ten checklist items complete. A \$240 maintenance invoice dated July 2 describes June service. Its posting period needs the accountant's review; no adjusting entry has been approved. Alex takes over the open-item follow-up at noon.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Alex: you accept follow-up at noon and need the invoice reference, service period, and current approval status.

Second round: The accountant is unavailable until tomorrow. State the owner and pending question without assigning an invented posting period.

Scenario 2 | A close folder with two unreviewed schedules

A fictional checklist marks cash and supplier schedules prepared, but both reviewer boxes are empty. The reviewer can take cash today; supplier review needs another named colleague.

Role A: Bookkeeper: distinguish prepared from reviewed and arrange the two ownership checks orally.

Role B: Reviewer: accept cash review only and ask who will take suppliers.

Possible opening: Both schedules are prepared, but neither has a recorded review yet.

Success checks

- Separate file preparation from review completion.
- Confirm the cash reviewer.
- Keep supplier review unassigned until someone accepts it.

Add a complication: A manager asks to report the entire folder as complete because all files are present.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 08 / READ AND NOTICE

Correcting records while preserving the trail

Repair an inaccurate status and preserve the distinction between an entry and a payment.

SITUATION

In fictional tracker version 3, invoice J14 for \$180 appears twice because the same file was imported twice. The controller confirmed one duplicate. No ledger correction has been posted. A previous message wrongly said the duplicate payment had been recovered; no duplicate payment is established.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

audit trail - A traceable history linking a transaction to its source, changes, and review records.

reversal - An entry that offsets an earlier accounting entry, rather than merely deleting its visible record.

duplicate entry - A second recording of the same transaction where only one recording was intended.

version history - A record of successive document or data versions and their changes.

Useful word combinations

trace the original entry: locate the transaction being corrected

cross-reference a correction: link the new record to the earlier one

identify the current version: distinguish the active record from superseded copies

explain the correction reason: state what changed and why

LESSON 08 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Correct the claim, not just the number

3. Notice the language

State exactly what the earlier message got wrong. A duplicate document, entry, and payment are different findings. Refer to the original record and correction status without teaching a universal reversal method.

I incorrectly described ___ as ___.

The confirmed finding is ___; we have not established ___.

The correction refers back to ___ and is currently ___.

Compare this wording: The duplicate payment is recovered.

Clearer: A duplicate invoice entry is confirmed. A duplicate payment has not been established, and the ledger correction is pending.

The corrected statement removes unsupported claims about both payment and recovery.

4. Check the language

1. Controller: Did the bank send money twice?

Clerk: We have confirmed a duplicate ___, not a duplicate payment.

A. refund

B. disbursement

C. settlement

D. entry

2. Colleague: Which tracker should I use?

Clerk: Version four ___ version three; the earlier version remains in the history.

A. precedes

B. matches

C. supersedes

D. duplicates

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

An entry was duplicated, not a payment confirmed

A fictional clerk corrects a message about J14 in tracker version three.

01 • Clerk: I need to correct my earlier message. I called J14 a recovered duplicate payment, which wasn't established.

02 • Controller: What's confirmed, and what's unknown about the one-hundred-eighty-dollar item?

03 • Clerk: You confirmed a duplicate invoice entry in tracker version three. We haven't established duplicate cash movement.

04 • Controller: That's right. Has a ledger correction been posted since we last discussed the tracker?

05 • Clerk: No. The ledger review remains pending. My message overstated both the payment finding and the recovery.

06 • Controller: Please correct that with the same recipients so they don't keep repeating the stronger claim.

07 • Clerk: I will say duplicate entry confirmed, duplicate payment unestablished, and ledger correction pending your review.

08 • Controller: Include the original entry reference. A reader should be able to follow what we are actually correcting.

09 • Clerk: I've linked J14 and version three. The correction addresses the claim as well as the amount.

10 • Controller: Thank you. Keep the record issue separate from any payment tracing that may follow.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

The correction email pointed to the old file

A fictional bookkeeper repairs a version-link mistake with a colleague.

01 • Colleague: Your message says corrected, but the attachment still duplicates invoice M8.

02 • Bookkeeper: You're right. I linked version two instead of version three, which contains the reviewed tracker correction.

03 • Colleague: So I wasn't looking at the current version. Can you identify precisely what changed between them?

04 • Bookkeeper: Version three removes the repeated tracker line and links the original transaction.

05 • Colleague: Does that mean the ledger was changed as well, or is this only the tracker?

06 • Bookkeeper: Only the tracker. The ledger had one entry, so no ledger correction was needed.

07 • Colleague: Thanks. Please send the correct link and label the earlier attachment superseded rather than letting both seem current.

08 • Bookkeeper: I've corrected the link now. The message explicitly identifies version three and the scope of the change.

09 • Colleague: I see the note and single line. That resolves my version confusion.

10 • Bookkeeper: I'll leave version two marked superseded in the version history, preserving the audit trail.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A proposed reversal is still only a proposal

A fictional clerk clarifies the status of an accounting correction during a review call.

01 • Reviewer: The query says reversal prepared. Has the original entry already been offset?

02 • Accounts clerk: No. Prepared refers to the draft correction request; the proposed reversal has not been posted.

03 • Reviewer: I read it as completed because the task was marked done in the document-preparation column.

04 • Accounts clerk: That label was too broad. I'll identify preparation as complete and accounting approval as pending.

05 • Reviewer: Please also confirm which original transaction the proposal refers to, since two references look similar.

06 • Accounts clerk: It refers to entry six eighteen for eighty dollars, not entry six eighty for eighteen dollars.

07 • Reviewer: Good distinction. Reading those references aloud without the amounts could easily cause another mix-up.

08 • Accounts clerk: I'll state both reference and amount together, and keep the original entry linked in the request.

09 • Reviewer: Then I can review the intended correction without assuming anything has already changed in the ledger.

10 • Accounts clerk: Exactly. Draft prepared for entry six eighteen, eighty dollars; approval and posting remain separate, unfinished stages.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Correcting records while preserving the trail

In fictional tracker version 3, invoice J14 for \$180 appears twice because the same file was imported twice. The controller confirmed one duplicate. No ledger correction has been posted. A previous message wrongly said the duplicate payment had been recovered; no duplicate payment is established.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Controller: one duplicate entry is confirmed; payment tracing has not established duplicate cash movement. Ask the clerk to correct the earlier claim.

Second round: A colleague proposes calling the issue fully fixed after updating the tracker. Distinguish the tracker correction from the still-pending ledger review.

Scenario 2 | The wrong employee reference in a correction query

A fictional payroll query names employee R14, but the attached supporting note concerns R41. No pay change has been made. The payroll lead can confirm the intended record before review resumes.

Role A: Payroll assistant: acknowledge the transposed reference and pause the ambiguous query, not the employee's pay.

Role B: Payroll lead: ask which evidence identifies the intended record; you can confirm R41 from the note.

Possible opening: The query reference and supporting note disagree; no pay change has been made.

Success checks

- Correct the record reference using the supplied evidence.
- Do not infer an incorrect payment from a query error.
- Restate R41 and the unchanged payment status.

Add a complication: A colleague calls the mismatch proof that the wrong person was paid.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

Answer workshop

Try the tasks first. The model is one acceptable response to scenario 1, not a script to memorize. Assess your spoken version using the four criteria at the end.

01 | Matching an invoice to its supporting records

Editing example: The invoice lists twelve lamps, but our available receiving record lists ten. Was there a separate delivery?

The revised question identifies the evidence gap without treating an unexplained difference as a confirmed error.

Check 1: C - whether the other two lamps were received

A: The due date concerns timing, not receipt.

B: The requester does not establish how many arrived.

C: Correct. Receipt of the remaining two is the missing fact.

D: Price does not resolve this quantity difference.

Check 2: B - unresolved

A: Credited would imply a credit note already exists.

B: Correct. Unresolved preserves the open question.

C: Settled would imply the issue is resolved.

D: Overdue describes a missed due date, not this evidence gap.

Model response: Invoice A184 and purchase order P61 both show twelve lamps, while receiving record R9 shows ten. Could you confirm whether the other two arrived separately or remain outstanding? I need the related delivery reference before I can describe the invoice as fully matched. At present, the two-lamp difference is unresolved.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

02 | Explaining receipts and outstanding customer balances

Editing example: The open invoices total a thousand dollars, and we also have your six-hundred-dollar receipt awaiting allocation.

The correction acknowledges cash already received instead of presenting the gross invoice balance as the entire position.

Check 1: B - allocation

A: A write-off removes a balance on another basis; it does not identify this receipt's intended allocation.

B: Correct. Allocation links the recorded receipt to the intended invoice.

C: Bank clearance is different from identifying which invoice this receipt covers.

D: A refund returns money rather than linking this receipt to an invoice.

Check 2: A - alongside

A: Correct. Alongside means presenting the two relevant items together.

B: Replacing the receipt with the balance hides information.

C: Regardless of would disregard money received.

D: Ahead of suggests sequence or priority rather than a combined explanation.

Model response: We have received Pine's six hundred dollars, but the invoice allocation is still unconfirmed. The open invoices total one thousand dollars; the unapplied receipt must be shown alongside them. A remittance advice identifies what the customer intended to pay. Could you confirm the invoice reference so we can explain the remaining balance accurately?

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

03 | Qualifying a bank reconciliation difference

Editing example: The difference matches a deposit recorded internally on June thirty and appearing at the bank on July first.

The revision describes a supported timing difference instead of suggesting missing money.

Check 1: A - outstanding

A: Correct. Outstanding means not yet completed in this context.

B: Complete contradicts the remaining checks' pending status.

C: No decision to waive the remaining checks is supplied.

D: The case describes unfinished checks, not checks repeated by mistake.

Check 2: D - consistent with

A: The later bank entry supports rather than contradicts timing.

B: Independent of wrongly disconnects the evidence.

C: Unrelated to rejects the connection supported by the dates.

D: Correct. The later appearance supports the timing explanation.

Model response: The three-hundred-dollar deposit recorded on June thirty appears in the bank's July first activity. That supports a timing explanation for this item. It does not establish that the whole reconciliation is complete, because the other checks are still open. I would label this deposit as traced and keep the overall review pending.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

04 | Requesting evidence for time exceptions

Editing example: Please check the missing Tuesday clock-out against the work log; the roster and Eli's recollection differ by thirty minutes.

The request asks for the disputed fact rather than treating usual hours as actual hours.

Check 1: D - what time Eli actually finished

A: Roster ownership does not establish actual finish time.

B: The next period does not resolve Tuesday's record.

C: Usual duration is not evidence of this shift's duration.

D: Correct. The request identifies the missing actual time.

Check 2: C - by

A: Since marks a starting point continuing afterward.

B: During needs a period, not this clock-time deadline.

C: Correct. By sets the deadline and permits an earlier return.

D: Until describes duration, not the latest delivery time.

Model response: Could you review Eli's Tuesday finish time against the work log and confirm the supported correction before our internal two o'clock approval cutoff? The roster shows five, while Eli recalls five thirty. Neither should be presented as verified yet. If the evidence is still incomplete, please return the exception with that uncertainty clearly stated.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

05 | Explaining a payroll preview

Editing example: Gross pay is unchanged; the preview shows fifty dollars more in deductions and fifty dollars less in net pay.

The revision avoids describing a deduction change as a change in the underlying gross earnings.

Check 1: C - whereas

A: Unless introduces a condition absent from the facts.

B: Before introduces a time sequence not supplied.

C: Correct. Whereas contrasts unchanged gross pay with changed deductions.

D: Because would claim the deduction increase caused unchanged gross pay.

Check 2: B - pending

A: Balanced does not mean evidence has been provided.

B: Correct. The record has not yet been confirmed.

C: Recurring describes frequency rather than review status.

D: Net describes a remaining amount, not a missing record.

Model response: Both previews show gross pay of twelve hundred dollars. Preview B has fifty dollars more in deductions, so the displayed net pay is fifty dollars lower. The new line explains the arithmetic difference, but its supporting record is still pending. Could you check that line before we describe preview B as ready for final approval?

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

06 | Making approval status unambiguous

Editing example: Seven invoices have recorded approval; their proposed payment batch has not been released.

The revised status does not turn completed review into completed payment.

Check 1: B - but is awaiting

A: Regardless of obscures the requested status.

B: Correct. Awaiting states that release is still pending.

C: Following implies release already happened.

D: In place of makes preparation a substitute for release.

Check 2: A - receiving document

A: Correct. The case identifies receipt evidence as the blocker.

B: No missing payment date is given.

C: The bank balance does not establish goods received.

D: The authority guide is not the missing document in this case.

Model response: Seven invoices have recorded approval and are included in the proposed batch. V22 is excluded because its receiving document is still missing. The batch has not been released. The approver returns at three, when I can present the seven-item proposal and report separately on the missing document without calling the payments completed.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

07 | Handing over a period-close review

Editing example: Nine checks are complete. Alex is taking over the maintenance invoice's posting-period query with the accountant.

The revision identifies the unfinished work and its owner without implying the close is complete.

Check 1: A - subject to

A: Correct. Subject to means dependent on the review outcome.

B: The posting-period decision depends on this review; it is not separate from it.

C: An undecided period is not evidence that the review occurred.

D: Subsequent to would place it after a review; the question concerns a pending decision.

Check 2: D - am taking over

A: The query is still open, not completed.

B: Alex is not approving the accounting treatment.

C: Reversing would suggest undoing an entry or decision.

D: Correct. Taking over accepts follow-up responsibility.

Model response: Nine of the ten June close checks are complete. The open item is the two-hundred-forty-dollar maintenance invoice dated July second for June service. Its posting period needs the accountant's review, and no adjustment is approved. Alex, please confirm that you are taking over that follow-up and will keep the close status pending until the review outcome is recorded.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

08 | Correcting records while preserving the trail

Editing example: A duplicate invoice entry is confirmed. A duplicate payment has not been established, and the ledger correction is pending.

The corrected statement removes unsupported claims about both payment and recovery.

Check 1: D - entry

A: Refund implies money returned, which is unconfirmed.

B: Disbursement means money paid out, the claim being corrected.

C: Settlement implies payment of an obligation, not the repeated record.

D: Correct. The confirmed issue is a repeated invoice entry.

Check 2: C - supersedes

A: Precedes would put version four before version three, reversing the sequence.

B: Matches suggests equivalent content rather than identifying the current replacement.

C: Correct. Supersedes identifies the newer version as the current one.

D: Duplicates means repeats, not replaces as the current version.

Model response: My earlier message confused a duplicate entry with a duplicate payment. The controller has confirmed a repeated one-hundred-eighty-dollar invoice entry in tracker version three; we have not established that money was paid twice. No ledger correction has been posted. I am correcting the status now and linking the original entry for the controller's review of the required correction.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and switches roles and repeats the exchange. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

All organizations, records, amounts, deadlines, and incidents are fictional English-language practice. This course is not accounting, payroll-system, tax, employment-law, financial, or payment-processing advice. Internal deadlines in the exercises are not legal rules. Refer pay entitlements, deductions, posting treatments, corrections, and payment decisions to the responsible qualified people and applicable local requirements. Use invented employee and account details only.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics: Bookkeeping, Accounting, and Auditing Clerks

<https://www.bls.gov/ooh/office-and-administrative-support/bookkeeping-accounting-and-auditing-clerks.htm>

U.S. Department of Labor: Fact Sheet 21, Recordkeeping Requirements

<https://www.dol.gov/agencies/whd/fact-sheets/21-flsa-recordkeeping>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the following prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Vocabulary and grammar prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has four practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

Each starter prompt uses B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-30. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Practice grammar in context

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Bookkeeping and Payroll English

Professional audience: Bookkeepers, accounts payable and receivable clerks, payroll clerks, and accounting assistants

Scope: All organizations, records, amounts, deadlines, and incidents are fictional English-language practice. This course is not accounting, payroll-system, tax, employment-law, financial, or payment-processing advice. Internal deadlines in the exercises are not legal rules. Refer pay entitlements, deductions, posting treatments, corrections, and payment decisions to the responsible qualified people and applicable local requirements. Use invented employee and account details only.

Lesson 01: Matching an invoice to its supporting records

Original fictional case: Fictional supplier Alder bills twelve desk lamps on invoice A184. Purchase order P61 lists twelve, but receiving record R9 lists ten. The remaining two may be on another delivery; no second record is available.

Language workshop: Locate the exact mismatch

Communication goal: Clarify which document supports a billed quantity.

Language guidance: Name the invoice, order, and receiving record separately. Agreement between two documents does not settle a third document's different quantity. Ask about the missing evidence without assuming either a supplier error or an unrecorded delivery.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): The invoice shows ___, whereas the receiving record shows ___. / Could you confirm whether ___ arrived separately? / Which reference supports the remaining ___?

Vocabulary: invoice: A supplier's or seller's bill listing goods or services and the amount requested. /

purchase order: A buyer's purchasing document specifying the goods or services ordered. / receiving

record: A record of the goods or quantities actually received by an organization. / credit note: A seller's

document reducing an amount previously billed, with a reference to the relevant charge.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Buyer: you ordered twelve lamps and can see only R9. The warehouse can check whether a second delivery occurred.

Guided response task: Complete a workplace dialogue by selecting one of four supplied options. Compare the feedback and say the completed exchange aloud. Do not write an open-ended message.

Optional second-round challenge: The supplier sends the purchase order again. Explain why it confirms the order quantity but not receipt.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: Invoice A184 and purchase order P61 both show twelve lamps, while receiving record R9 shows ten. Could you confirm whether the other two arrived separately or remain outstanding? I need the related delivery reference before I can describe the invoice as fully matched. At present, the two-lamp difference is unresolved.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Choose grammar that preserves the meaning

1. Use the lesson's language workshop, or one actual sentence from the dialogue, to explain a single grammar distinction in no more than 90 words. Show how it affects timing, certainty, responsibility or politeness.
2. Give one brief occupational exchange containing a gap and four complete options A-D. Supply enough context for exactly one answer. Keep distractors plausible; distinguish grammar errors from wording that changes the facts. Stop and wait.
3. Explain why each choice fits or fails, then ask me to read the completed exchange aloud. Do not request a draft, original written sentence or essay.
4. Repeat with three new exchanges, one at a time, moving from recognition to a more subtle meaning contrast. Do not copy the published checks. Label invented variations and do not turn uncertainty into a promise.
5. End with a short contrast table and two supported spoken turns using supplied frames. Accept accurate alternatives in oral practice; acknowledge and replace ambiguous multiple-choice items.

END PROMPT